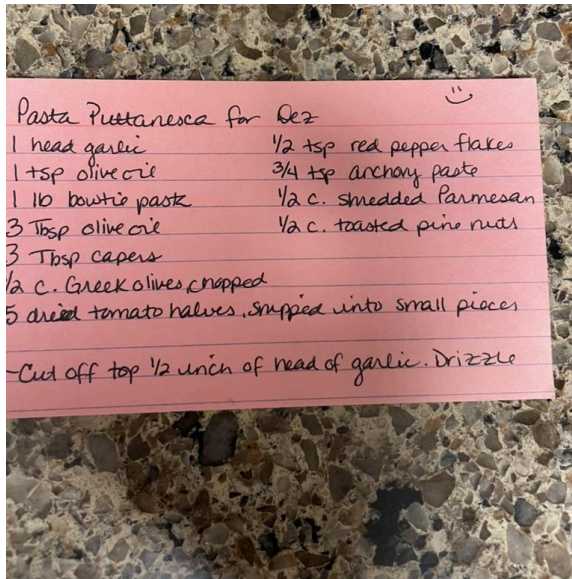


RECIPE

Pasta Puttanesca for Dez



Ready in **20 minutes**

Serves **8 people**

280 calories

Ingredients

- 1 head garlic
 - 1 tsp olive oil
- 1 lb bowtie pasta
- 3 Tbsp olive oil
- 3 Tbsp capers
- 1/2 c. Greek olives, chopped
- 5 dried tomato halves, snipped into small pieces
- 1/2 tsp red pepper flakes
- 3/4 tsp anchovy paste
- 1/2 c. shredded Parmesan
- 1/2 c. toasted pine nuts

Preparation

1. Roast the garlic. Cut off top 1/2 inch of head of garlic. Drizzle with 1 tsp olive oil. Wrap with aluminum foil, bake at 350° for 1 hour. Cool.
2. Make the sauce. Heat 3 Tbsp olive oil in skillet over medium-low heat. Add capers, heat until they "pop". Squeeze roasted garlic cloves into pan, add olives, dried tomatoes, red pepper flakes, and anchovy paste. Heat until warmed through.
3. Cook pasta. Cook bowtie pasta al dente in salted water.
4. Combine. Toss pasta with sauce in a large bowl.

5. **Finish. Sprinkle with shredded Parmesan and toasted pine nuts. Yum!**
6. **Variations. Add fresh basil, roasted asparagus, extra minced garlic, shrimp, chicken, red peppers, prosciutto, fresh spinach, or mushrooms. A squeeze of lemon brightens flavors; more olive oil makes it richer.**

Tips

From the original recipe: "A squeeze of lemon brightens flavors, more olive oil makes it richer." (handwritten note)

From Simply Recipes: "Canned anchovies" are an essential element of pasta puttanesca.

Source:

<https://www.simplyrecipes.com/recipes/pasta-puttanesca/>

From RecipeTin Eats: "Starch that's left in the cooking water helps emulsify the fats and water in the sauce." Source:

<https://www.recipetineats.com/spaghetti-all-a-puttanesca/>

From Bowl of Delicious: "The anchovies add an intense savory, umami-packed flavor."

Source:

<https://www.bowlofdelicious.com/pasta-puttanesca/>

Spaghetti Aglio e Olio

Source:

<https://www.gimmesomeoven.com/spaghetti-aglio-e-olio/>

Ingredients

1 lb spaghetti

½ cup olive oil

6 cloves garlic, thinly sliced

¼ tsp red pepper flakes

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

½ cup grated Parmesan (optional)

Fresh parsley, minced

Preparation

Cook spaghetti in salted boiling water until just before al dente; reserve ¼ cup pasta water.

In a large skillet over medium-low heat, sauté sliced garlic and red pepper flakes in olive oil for 2–3 minutes until just golden.

Add drained spaghetti and reserved pasta water; toss to coat.

Finish with Parmesan, parsley, salt, and pepper.

Tips

From Allrecipes: “The key is slowly toasting the garlic slices to a perfect golden brown in the olive oil.” Source: <https://www.allrecipes.com/recipe/222000/spaghetti-aglio-e-olio/>

From Coley Cooks: “If the garlic starts browning unevenly or too fast, reduce the heat immediately and add a splash of water.”

Source:

<https://coleycooks.com/pasta-aglio-e-olio/>

From The Mediterranean Dish: “Watch the garlic to make sure it takes on the perfect toasty, golden hue.” Source: <https://www.themediterraneandish.com/spaghetti-aglio-e-olio/>

Pasta al Limone

Source:

<https://www.billyparisi.com/pasta-al-limone/>

Ingredients

1 lb spaghetti or bucatini

4 Tbsp unsalted butter

2 Tbsp olive oil

Zest of 2 lemons

½ cup fresh lemon juice

1 cup grated Pecorino Romano

Salt and freshly ground black pepper

Preparation

Cook pasta in salted boiling water until al dente; reserve 2 cups pasta water.

In a large pan, melt butter with olive oil and lemon zest over medium heat.

Add half of the lemon juice and let simmer 2–3 minutes.

Add drained pasta and ½ cup pasta water; toss vigorously with the cheese to emulsify.

Add remaining lemon juice, salt, and pepper to taste; serve immediately.

Tips

From Chef Billy Parisi: “Toss the pasta repeatedly and vigorously to melt the cheese and emulsify it with hot water and pasta to make it creamy.” Source:

<https://www.billyparisi.com/pasta-al-limone/>

From Little Spice Jar: “If the sauce thickens too much at any point, use the pasta water to thin it back out again to your liking.” Source: <https://www.littlespicejar.com/creamy-lemon-garlic-pasta/>

From Pamela Salzman: “Save two cups of the pasta cooking liquid” before draining. Source: <https://pamelasalzman.com/easy-pasta-al-limone-recipe-with-bucatini-or-spaghetti/>

Pasta al Tonno

Source:

<https://www.sipandfeast.com/pasta-al-tonno/>

Ingredients

1 lb rigatoni

¼ cup extra virgin olive oil

6 cloves garlic, sliced

10–12 oz canned yellowfin tuna in olive oil

2 Tbsp capers, rinsed and drained

½ tsp crushed red pepper flakes

¼ cup fresh parsley, minced

2 anchovy fillets (optional)

24 oz tomato passata

Salt and black pepper

Preparation

Bring a large pot of salted water to a boil.

In a large pan over medium heat, sauté garlic and anchovies in olive oil until garlic is golden (2–3 minutes).

Add capers and red pepper flakes; cook 30 seconds.

Add tuna, breaking into pieces; stir in passata and bring to a gentle simmer.

Cook pasta until 1 minute less than al dente; transfer to sauce with a splash of pasta water.

Finish cooking pasta in sauce; top with parsley.

Tips

From Sip and Feast: “The tuna is the star of the show in this dish so use the best canned

or jarred tuna your budget permits.” Source: <https://www.sipandfeast.com/pasta-al-tonno/>

From Italy Translated: “Why not have tuna pasta instead?” Source: <https://italytranslated.com/2022/12/03/recipe-pasta-al-tonno-pasta-with-tuna/>

From Italian Connection: “Add the well-drained tuna, breaking it into pieces with a fork.” Source: <https://italian-connection.com/italian-food-culture/pasta-with-capers-olives-and-tuna/>

Cacio e Pepe

Source:

<https://www.gimmesomeoven.com/cacio-e-pepe/>

Ingredients

8 oz dried bucatini or spaghetti

2 Tbsp unsalted butter

2 oz finely grated Pecorino Romano (about ½ cup)

1 tsp freshly ground coarse black pepper

Kosher salt

Preparation

Bring a pot of lightly salted water to a boil; cook pasta until al dente. Reserve 1 cup pasta water.

Meanwhile, toast the cracked pepper in a dry skillet over medium heat until fragrant; add butter to melt.

Add a splash of pasta water to the pan and bring to a simmer.

Add drained pasta to the pan; toss vigorously.

Gradually sprinkle in the grated Pecorino while tossing, adding pasta water as needed, until a creamy sauce coats the pasta.

Serve immediately, topped with extra cheese and pepper.

Tips

From Gimme Some Oven: “It’s very important to freshly ground the black pepper to give this recipe optimum flavor.” Source: <https://www.gimmesomeoven.com/cacio-e-pepe/>

From Spoon Fork Bacon: “We love using a microplane to grate the cheese.” Source:

<https://www.spoonforkbacon.com/cacio-e-pepe-recipe/>

From YouTube (Foolproof Recipe Tips): “It’s one of those dishes where it all comes together really quickly and can easily be ruined if the cheese clumps.” Source: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fCu4ERVNGbk>

Penne all'Arrabbiata

Source:

<https://www.bonappetit.com/recipe/penne-allarrabbiata>

Ingredients

1 lb penne pasta

1/4 cup extra-virgin olive oil

6 garlic cloves, thinly sliced

1-2 tsp red pepper flakes (to taste)

1 (28 oz) can whole peeled tomatoes, crushed by hand

Kosher salt

1/4 cup chopped fresh parsley

Grated Pecorino Romano, for serving

Preparation

Bring a large pot of salted water to a boil; cook penne until al dente.

Meanwhile, heat olive oil in a large skillet over medium heat; add garlic and red pepper flakes and cook until garlic is golden, about 2 minutes.

Add crushed tomatoes and a pinch of salt; simmer until sauce thickens, 10–15 minutes.

Drain pasta, reserving 1/2 cup pasta water; add pasta to sauce with a splash of pasta water and toss to coat.

Stir in parsley; serve topped with grated Pecorino.

Tips

From Bon Appétit: "The key to a great arrabbiata is letting the garlic and chile bloom in the oil to infuse it with flavor."

Source:

<https://www.bonappetit.com/recipe/penne-allarrabbiata>

From Serious Eats: "Crushing the tomatoes by hand gives the sauce a more rustic texture than using a blender or food processor."

Source:

<https://www.seriouseats.com/penne-arrabbiata-spicy-italian-pasta-recipe>